PERKALATE / FITNESS AND WELLNESS

How to Fill Off Peak Classes With Partner Funded Perks

A practical playbook for gyms and studios: let partner brands fund perks for verified members and point them at your quiet hours.

Every schedule has dead spots. The 6am and 6pm classes are packed, and the 1pm or 8pm slots run half empty. You're paying instructors and keeping the lights on either way. Here's a playbook for turning those hours into a reason for members to come in, paid for by brands that want to reach them.

Step 1: Map your quiet hours

Pull attendance for the last eight weeks and mark every class or time block running below about half capacity. Pick the three to five slots you most want to fill. Don't try to fix the whole schedule at once.

Step 2: Decide who the perk is for

Narrow the audience. Good starting groups:

- New members who have visited once but not twice
- Members who haven't checked in for two or three weeks
- Members whose usual class is often full

Each group has a reason to try a quieter time, and none of them needs a membership discount to do it.

Step 3: Find partners who want your members

Your members are valuable to nearby businesses: smoothie and juice shops, healthy restaurants, apparel and footwear brands, recovery and massage services, nutrition products. Approach partners with a simple pitch: fund a reward for verified members of your gym, tied to specific hours, and get a clear report of how many members viewed, claimed and redeemed it.

Partners pay for the reward itself. You don't give up margin, and members get something from a brand they already like.

Step 4: Tie the perk to the place and time

The perk should unlock at your location during the hours you want to fill. A member scans a code at the front desk after the 1pm class and claims a drink from your juice bar partner, redeemable that afternoon. Or a member who attends two off peak classes in a week unlocks an online reward from an apparel partner.

Tying the reward to place and time is what turns it from a coupon into an attendance driver.

Step 5: Make claiming easy

Show the perk, time window, and eligibility rule before a member starts. Explain which information the check uses and give the member a clear choice to continue.

Step 6: Tell the right members, not everyone

Promote each perk to the group it's for. A quick note to new members after their first class, a sign at the front desk during the quiet hours, a mention from the instructor. Avoid blasting the whole list, which turns a targeted perk back into another discount.

Step 7: Review every two weeks

Look at views, claims and redemptions for each perk and each time slot. Keep what works, swap partners or offers on what doesn't, and move perks to new slots as the schedule fills.

A four week starter plan

- **Week 1:** Pick three quiet slots and two partners. Agree on the rewards and the reporting.
- **Week 2:** Launch one perk per slot for new members and lapsed members.
- **Week 3:** Check the funnel. Fix placement or offer on anything with low claims.
- **Week 4:** Compare attendance in those slots against the previous month and decide what to extend.

What partners should expect

Be clear that partners see audience totals and results, not member names. That protects your members, and it makes saying yes to partners easier, because no personal details leave your gym.

Plan a pilot

Choose one audience, one reward and one result to measure. Set the budget and eligibility rules before launch. Tell participants which information you need and share results in aggregate where possible.